murdered Jews is carried out again in her reference to Ravensbrück, a predominantly female concentration camp outside Berlin. In relation to her work with German feminists, this serves as a call to identification through critically addressing their pasts. Her final lines, “careful and monsterless / this urn makes nothing / easy to say,” respond to both the urn at Plötzensee and perhaps her own urn poem as limited in ability to find the utterances appropriate to encounter such a violent history. Further, like her reference to a nightingale in “Berlin Is Hard on Colored Girls,” the final lines conjure another classical symbol of poetry, the urn, and Keats’s canonical “Ode on a Grecian Urn.” Keats’s poem also mediates the gaps between speech and silence but owes its culminating lines to a lesson “spoken” by an urn and conveyed in quotation marks: “‘Beauty is truth, truth beauty,’—that is all / Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know.”[72] Lorde’s ending signifies and challenges Keats’s ode, akin to her formulations within her “Poetry Is Not a Luxury” essay, to remind her readers of the aesthetic limits of memorial gestures, be they poetic and/or material. The past can be localized into poems, aesthetic objects, and memorials, but true loss extends beyond speech acts made evident in sites of historical reflection. Overall, Lorde revisits the thematic extremes of soft and hard materiality in divided Berlin—the tensions between the inscription of the plaque and the physical traces it references, the offering of tangible earth that was sealed in the urn. Against these two material extremes, and between fine-grained detail and a bigger picture of the spaces wrought by division, Lorde conveys her own and a larger shared sense of divided Berlin as a simultaneous refuge and site of potential danger.

Finally, Lorde’s poem “Diaspora” in *Our Dead Behind Us*, departs from and extends outward visions of these previous poems that are clearly sited in Cold War Berlin. Lorde mined the city’s emergent diasporic identities and memorial displays and, in doing so, created a body of work that mapped the divided city into a larger, transnational vision of struggle incorporating multiple political hot spots of the period. But the site-specificity of some of her divided Berlin poems was also balanced by the abstracted Berlin imaginary from which she continually drew. For example, a different poem, “For Jose and Regina,” was titled in earlier drafts “Growing Up in Berlin.”[73] The poem “Diaspora,” however, bears the traces of her experiences of the divided city while expanding and confounding its city limits and symbolic landscape. The concept of diaspora is for Lorde tied to notions of danger and